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UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT, RAS AL KHAIMAH RULER REVIEW DEVELOPMENT PLANS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday received His Highness Sheikh Saud Bin Saqr Al Qasimi, Supreme Council Member and Ruler of Ras Al Khaimah. During the meeting, Their Highnesses reviewed a number of issues of national importance, including development plans aimed at enhancing quality of life and advancing the UAE's journey of progress.

DIFC plans to create 25,000 jobs with AI-native shift

Financial hub bets on AI to drive \$3.5b economic impact

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Dubai International Financial Centre said it plans to create around 25,000 jobs as part of its transition to become the world's first AI-native financial centre, embedding artificial intelligence across its core operations.

The initiative, branded as the Native AI programme, is expected to generate \$3.5 billion in economic benefits while reshaping how financial services are delivered within the centre. DIFC said AI will be integrated into legal and regulatory frameworks, enterprise systems, talent development and infrastructure, marking a

By 2030, parts of the district are expected to feature robotics, autonomous mobility and smart infrastructure, as Dubai pushes to strengthen its position as a global hub for finance and advanced technologies.

shift from pilot-based adoption to full-scale deployment.

Officials said the approach positions DIFC as a global model for AI adoption in finance, with the centre aiming to embed the technology into its operating system rather than treating it as a standalone tool. The move builds on a five-year AI strategy launched in 2023, which introduced data governance policies and incorporated AI into the DIFC Data Protection Law.

Chief Executive Arif Amiri said the programme would deliver "tangible impact" through job creation and economic value, while setting a benchmark for AI governance and innovation.

Access to AI tools

The plan includes developing new regulatory frameworks covering AI agents and robotics, alongside expanding access to advanced AI tools for firms operating within the centre. DIFC said it will invest in training programmes and certifications to support workforce development, as well as launch an AI campus combining regulation, computing and education. By 2030, parts of the district are expected to feature robotics, autonomous mobility and smart infrastructure, as Dubai pushes to strengthen its position as a global hub for finance and advanced technologies.

SEE ALSO P7

CLOCK TICKS ON TRUCE AS TRUMP RESISTS EXTENSION

Says talks inevitable, but no Iran team yet

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump signalled he is not inclined to extend the Iran ceasefire beyond its looming deadline, raising the risk of a return to conflict as fresh talks remain mired in uncertainty.

"I don't want to do that," Trump said when asked about extending the truce, adding that "we don't have that much time," and warning military action could resume if no deal is reached.

The ceasefire, in place since April 8, is due to expire late today in Washington (early tomorrow UAE time), with both sides accusing each other of repeated violations and no confirmed breakthrough in diplomacy.

Despite Tehran shunning new talks so far, Trump expressed confidence he could secure an agreement that favours Washington.

"We're going to end up with a great deal. I think they have no choice... We're in a very, very strong negotiating position," he told CNBC.

"Iran can get themselves on a very good footing if they make a deal," he added, insisting Tehran would ultimately come for talks in Islamabad.

Iranian state media, however, said "no delegation" had departed for Pakistan, underlining deep mistrust and uncertainty over the negotiations.

Talks under strain

Tehran has hardened its stance, with parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf saying Iran would not negotiate "under the shadow of threats" and warning it was prepared to "show new cards on the battlefield" if the conflict resumes.

GARGASH: UAE FIRM IN CONFRONTING THREATS

The UAE continues to demonstrate strength and resilience in the face of mounting challenges, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the President, said yesterday. He stressed that the current phase shows which nations can hold firm and distinguish themselves as the pace of change accelerates.

Writing on X, Gargash said moments of uncertainty often test national strength, adding that the UAE has consistently shown its capacity to navigate pressure through its leadership, values and institutions. "In times of challenge, the strength of nations is tested, and the UAE proves every day that it is a strong state powered by its leadership, values and institutions," he said.

He added that the country is firm in confronting threats, decisive in countering attempts to undermine security, and effective in managing its social and economic affairs with efficiency and fairness. Gargash said the UAE would continue to face challenges with confidence, reinforcing its ability to meet evolving tests and maintain stability in a fast-changing global environment.

—Gulf News Report

Iranian officials accused Washington of acting in bad faith, pointing to the US naval blockade of Iranian ports and the seizure of a vessel near the Strait of Hormuz as actions that undermine diplomacy.

Trump, meanwhile, accused Iran of violating the ceasefire "numerous times," including alleged attacks on vessels in the strategic waterway — claims Tehran has denied, instead blaming US actions for escalating tensions.

Pakistan's last-ditch push

With the truce window narrowing, Pakistan has stepped up mediation efforts in a bid to salvage negotiations.

Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar urged both sides to consider extending the ceasefire and give diplomacy a chance, as Islamabad ramped up security and prepared for possible high-level talks.

A US delegation led by Vice-President JD Vance is expected to travel to Pakistan, though there has been no confirmation of Iranian participation.

Diplomatic sources say Pa-

kistan is working "down to the wire" to bring both sides together, but prospects for a breakthrough remain uncertain.

Escalation risks rise

Trump has paired diplomatic overtures with stark warnings, reiterating that the US military is "raring to go" and could resume strikes if negotiations fail.

Analysts say the conflicting signals — pressure on one hand, diplomacy on the other — are complicating efforts to build trust at a critical moment.

Fragile pause

Even as talks are discussed, the reality on the ground points to a fragile pause rather than a durable resolution.

With Iran refusing to negotiate under pressure, the US unwilling to ease its demands, and Pakistan racing to broker dialogue, the coming hours are likely to determine whether the ceasefire holds — or gives way to renewed escalation.

The clock is ticking — and the path to diplomacy remains uncertain.

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No reduced tuition fee or refunds for distance learning

KHDA: Fees payable if schools deliver approved remote learning

DUBAI

BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

While the majority of private schools in Dubai have reopened since Monday, some schools are still continuing with distance learning. During this period, schools are not allowed to reduce, discount, or waive any part of the tuition fees solely because lessons are being delivered remotely, according to the Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) registration and refund policy for Dubai's private schools.

The policy clearly states that if schooling is interrupted due to a government-enforced clo-

sure, tuition fees must still be paid as long as teaching continues, including through distance learning. So, according to KHDA, schools that are delivering an approved distance learning programme are not required to reduce, discount, or waive any portion of the KHDA-approved tuition fees on the basis that education is being provided remotely.

The policy also states that a parent choosing not to engage with remote learning does not justify withholding or reducing fees. If there are concerns about the quality or delivery of teaching during this period, these must be raised through the school's internal complaints process. Tuition fees must still be paid in full while any complaint is being reviewed.

Key point for parents

Tuition fees are payable to the school for each day that the service was available and delivered. From the day the school is unable



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

Students arrive for classes at Raffles World Academy, Dubai.

to deliver its service, tuition fees are no longer payable. Schools are also permitted to retain all fees for periods when services are delivered, with such payments deemed non-refundable.

Where a school fails to deliver its service, parents are entitled to a refund for that period. Any re-

fund must be agreed in writing between the school and the parent through one of the following three methods:

■ **Credit note:** The school issues a formal credit note for the eligible amount, which can be applied to future tuition fees if the student remains enrolled at

the same school once services resume. If the student does not return, the remaining amount must be refunded to the parent.

■ **Transfer of credit:** If the family has another child at the same school or plans to enrol one, the amount can be transferred and used towards the sibling's tuition fees.

■ **Full refund:** The full amount is returned to the parent for the period during which the school was unable to deliver its services.

If a school temporarily suspends or reduces its services for reasons within its own control, specific rules apply.

The school must inform parents in writing as soon as the decision is made, including the reason and expected duration.

Tuition fees must still be paid for any period where services continue to be provided. For any period where services are not provided, the school must compensate parents.